Kavya Ravindranath

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Education

George Washington University
Ph.D. Economics, 2021-

Madras School of Economics, India
M.A. Economics, 2019 *(with Distinction)*

St. Xavier's College, India
B.A. Economics, 2017 *(with Distinction)*

Fields

Public, Political Economy, Development, Environmental

References

Dr. Elira Kuka
ekuka@gwu.edu

Dr. Tanner Regan
tanner_regan@gwu.edu

Dr. Paul Carrillo
pcarrill@gwu.edu

Dr. Remi Jedwab
jedwab@gwu.edu

Working Papers

Raising Revenues: Evidence from Property Tax Assessments in India (Job Market Paper)

Bridging the Solar Divide: Demand Responses to Subsidies among Low-Income Households with Rui Zhong

How much influence does a bureaucrat have? A study of caste and crime in India

Political Economy of State Borrowing and Financial Crowding Out with Viral Acharya, Nirupama Kulkarni, and Rahul Singh Chauhan

Papers in Progress

Pass-Through of Consumption Taxes under Political Pressure with Sai Pitre

Digital Land and Property Improvement Tax Payment Mechanism in Malawi with Klaus W. Deininger and Daniel Ayalew Ali
Trial pre-registered at https://www.socialscienceregistry.org/trials/19261

Policy Publications

Progressive tax rate bands and the state of property tax in Kampala
with Nathaniel Badalov, Julius Mutebi, Tanner Regan and Ezra Ssebuwufu
International Growth Centre, 2025

Understanding Sovereign Ratings and Their Implications for Emerging Economies
with Nirupama Kulkarni, Gautham Udupa, Kaushalendra Kishore, Ilisa Goenka and Rahul Singh Chauhan
Economic & Political Weekly, 2023

Fellowships & Awards

Lincoln Institute of Land Policy C. Lowell Harriss Dissertation Fellowship: 2026
John W. Kendrick Endowed Summer Award: 2023, 2024, 2025
GW CCAS Doctoral Fellowship: 2021 – 2025

Research Experience

Consultant - World Bank Group DECRG, Dec 2025–Aug 2026; *PI: Dr. Klaus Deininger*
Research Associate, 2025–2026; *PI: Dr. Elira Kuka*
Consultant - International Finance Corporation, Summer 2025
Research Associate, Summer 2023, Summer 2024; *PI: Dr. Tanner Regan*
Research Associate - Energy and Environment Lab, University of Chicago, Summer 2022; *PIs: Dr. Fiona Burlig and Dr. Ludovica Gazze*
Research Associate - Center for Advanced Financial Research and Learning, Reserve Bank of India, 2019–2021; *PI: Dr. Nirupama Kulkarni*

Seminars & Conferences

2027 - ASSA [+] (Poster)
2026 - World Bank/IFS/ODI Tax Conference (Discussant), DMV PhD Conference on Political Economy & Development[+], NTA[+], APPAM[*+]
2023 - World Bank/IFS/ODI Tax Conference
[*] *Presented by co-author,* [+]*Scheduled*

Memberships

NTA, AEA, APPAM, AREUEA

Teaching

Principles of Microeconomics: Fall 2021: *Prof Anthony Yezer*; Spring 2021, Fall 2022, Fall 2024: *Prof Daniel Mackay*
Principles of Macroeconomics: Spring 2022, Fall 2023: *Prof Ronald Bird*; Spring 2024: *Prof Roberto Samaniego*
Introduction to Econometrics: Spring 2025: *Prof Alessandra Fenizia*

Technical skills

Software: Stata, Python, LaTeX, R, SQL
GIS: QGIS, ArcGIS
Other: Git, Qualtrics, Tableau

Pre-Doctoral Leadership and Extra Curricular

General Secretary, Social Service League, St. Xavier's College – 2016
Member, Student Council, St. Xavier's College – 2016
Editor, Economics Seminar – 2016
Assistent General Secretary, Social Service League, St. Xavier's College – 2015
Organizer: Fine Arts, Malhar, St. Xavier's College – 2015
Writer, The Xavier's Economics Newsletter – 2013, 2014

Citizenship

India, valid work authorization for the United States